

Supporting Smoking Cessation through Policies and Campaigns



Promoting smoking cessation aligns with UK government and international initiatives offering resources for health professionals and patients. Key policies and campaigns include:

Stoptober Campaign

<https://www.nhs.uk/better-health/quit-smoking/>

NHS Quit Smoking Service

<https://www.nhs.uk/live-well/quit-smoking/>

UK Tobacco Control Plan

<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/towards-a-smoke-free-generation-tobacco-control-plan-for-england>

Role of Health Professionals (Nurses) in Smoking Cessation



Nurses are vital in smoking cessation efforts, integrating strategies like the Making Every Contact Count (MECC) approach into care (PHE & NHS, 2016). They educate patients on smoking risks, particularly its links to diseases like lung cancer and heart disease, while addressing barriers such as addiction and mental health challenges.

Nurses provide tailored support, including nicotine replacement therapies and counseling. Their advocacy for smoke-free policies and trust-building empowers patients to quit successfully, contributing significantly to reducing smoking prevalence and improving public health.

Useful Resources & Websites

<https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/uk-health-security-agency>

<https://www.ons.gov.uk/peoplepopulationandcommunity/healthandsocialcare/healthandlifeexpectancies/bulletins/adultsmokinghabitsintheuk/latest>

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/tobacco>

<https://tobaccoatlas.org/challenges/prevalence/>

<https://www.rcpsych.ac.uk/news-and-features/latest-news/detail/2022/06/13/rcpsych-welcome-focus-on-mental-health-in-new-anti-smoking-proposals>

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Jackson, S. E., Garnett, C., & Brown, J. (2020). Prevalence and correlates of receipt by smokers of general practitioner advice on smoking cessation in England: A cross-sectional survey of adults. *Addiction (Abingdon, England)*, 116(2), 358. <https://doi.org/10.1111/add.15187>

UK Health Security Agency (2021). Tobacco and health disparities. A report on the impact of smoking and tobacco control measures in the UK. <https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/uk-health-security-agency>

World Health Organization (WHO, 2023). Global smoking statistics and cessation benefits. Comprehensive global data on tobacco use and its health impact, emphasizing the benefits of quitting smoking. <https://www.who.int/health-topics/tobacco>

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A Smoke-Free Future: Promoting Health and Well-Being



This leaflet is design for healthcare professionals particularly nurses in the UK, to empower them with practical tools, evidence-based strategies, and vital resources to inspire and support their patients in quitting smoking and leading healthier lives.



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"Quit Today for a Healthier Tomorrow!"

Enrolment number:



Impact of Smoking and Promoting a Smoke-Free Life

Smoking is a global health crisis, causing over 8 million preventable deaths annually, including 1.2 million from second-hand smoke (WHO, 2023). While high-income countries like the UK and US have reduced smoking rates, tobacco use continues to rise in low- and middle-income nations due to weak policies and aggressive marketing. Smoking-related deaths in regions like Southeast Asia and Africa are projected to increase by 20% over the next decade, deepening global health disparities (Global Burden of Disease Study, 2023).

In the UK, smoking causes 78,000 deaths annually, with illnesses like lung cancer, chronic obstructive pulmonary disease (COPD), and cardiovascular disease dominating (ASH, 2024). Economically, smoking costs the NHS £2.5 billion each year, with lost productivity pushing the total impact to £12.6 billion far exceeding the costs of obesity and alcohol-related harm. Highlighting the urgency of robust tobacco control measures (UK Health Security Agency, 2021)

Despite progress, with rates dropping from 20.2% in 2011 to 13.3% in 2023 (ONS, 2023), smoking remains prevalent among low-income groups. Targeted marketing, stress, and limited cessation resources perpetuate inequities (ASH, 2024). Tailored, equitable interventions are critical to addressing these disparities and achieving a smoke-free society.

Determinants of Smoking Prevalence and Health Promotion

Several key determinants significantly impact smoking prevalence, requiring targeted interventions to promote health and well-being.

Socioeconomic Status: Smoking rates are higher among lower socioeconomic groups due to increased stress and tobacco companies' aggressive marketing (Hiscock et al., 2015). Financial barriers, despite rising taxes, prevent many from quitting.

Educational Barriers: Low awareness of smoking risks and cessation support exacerbates the issue. Research shows only 48% of smokers are aware of NHS cessation services (Jackson et al., 2020), highlighting the need for improved health literacy.

Mental Health: Smoking is prevalent among individuals with mental health conditions, often used as a coping mechanism (Royal College of Psychiatrists, 2022). Without addressing both mental health and smoking, cessation efforts remain limited.

Strategies for Smoking Prevention and Cessation



Health professionals must focus on health education and literacy, policy measures like plain packaging, and mental health support integrated with cessation services. Expanding successful health campaigns and utilizing digital tools can further enhance smoking cessation efforts (PHE, 2024; Global Tobacco Atlas, 2023).

Health Belief Model for Smoking Cessation (Becker, 1974);



Perceived Susceptibility: Smokers assess their risk of developing illnesses like lung cancer, with smokers being 15–30 times more likely to be affected (CDC, 2020). Health professionals can personalize this understanding using tools like lung function tests or family history discussions.

Perceived Severity: Smokers must recognize the serious consequences of their behavior. Smoking causes over 8 million deaths annually (WHO, 2021). Highlighting outcomes like reduced life expectancy and diminished quality of life helps motivate change.

Perceived Benefits: This stage emphasizes the advantages of quitting. Within one year, the risk of heart disease is halved, and lung function begins to improve (WHO, 2021). Professionals can stress benefits like financial savings and improved physical activity.

Perceived Barriers: Challenges such as withdrawal symptoms, fear of weight gain, or social pressures may deter smokers. Health professionals can address these barriers with nicotine replacement therapy, support groups, or medication.

Cues to Action: External prompts, such as public health campaigns or family reminders, encourage quitting.

Self-Efficacy: Building confidence through coping strategies, stress management, and celebrating milestones ensures long-term success.